



THE LUTEAL PHASE

What Happens After Ovulation?

The luteal phase is the second half of the menstrual cycle. It begins after ovulation and ends when the next period starts. Its main role is to prepare the uterus for a possible pregnancy.

During this phase, hormones help make the uterine lining thick and stable. If pregnancy does not occur, hormone levels drop and menstruation begins.

What Happens During the Luteal Phase

- The follicle becomes the corpus luteum
- Progesterone rises (key hormone of this phase)
- The uterine lining thickens to support implantation
- Cervical mucus becomes thicker
- If pregnancy doesn't occur, hormones fall and the cycle resets

Why the Luteal Phase Matters

The luteal phase supports early pregnancy by:

- Maintaining a healthy uterine lining
- Preparing the uterus for implantation
- Supporting early pregnancy before the placenta develops

A short luteal phase may make pregnancy more difficult.

Signs You May Be in the Luteal Phase

- Slight increase in basal body temperature
- Thicker, drier cervical mucus
- PMS-like symptoms such as bloating, mood changes, or breast tenderness

Key Takeaway

The luteal phase prepares the body for pregnancy after ovulation. A healthy luteal phase is important for implantation and early pregnancy support.

Bloom provides educational guidance only. Always consult with a qualified healthcare professional for personalized medical advice.

*Educational content informed by Cleveland Clinic. (2022). Luteal phase.
American Society for Reproductive Medicine. (2021).
Merck Manual. (2022). Menstrual cycle.*